

MAKE A DIFFERENCE FUND

TSUNAMI 2004



Helping HAND

CARE TODAY-supported warehouses help 1,290 farmers' families in Nagapattinam



(ABOVE) CARE TODAY EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR C. BALAJI SINGH (FOURTH FROM RIGHT) WITH VILLAGERS AT THE WAREHOUSE IN KOVILPATHU; (BELOW) VILLAGERS ACKNOWLEDGE INDIA TODAY'S HELP IN PRATAPRAMAPURAM VILLAGE



C. BALAJI SINGH

When the tsunami struck in December 2004, Nagapattinam district in Tamil Nadu was among the worst affected. CARE TODAY has been working in the affected areas since and the latest project under the auspices of its Make a Difference fund involves building warehouses at three villages—Kovilpathu, Pratapramapuram and Thandavanajkulam—in the district, teaming up with the Dhan Foundation, a local NGO. The result of the collaborative work undertaken by the two organisations has high visibility in the area. While the warehouses at Pratapramapuram and Thandavanajkulam villages are under construction, the one at Kovilpathu is complete and is being used by the villagers for storing groundnut seeds. The community and Dhan Foundation representatives are hopeful that the construction work in Pratapramapuram and Thandavanajkulam would be complete latest by August-end.

The three warehouses together would benefit 1,290 farmer families in these villages and would be used by them to store their produce and sell it at a time when they get a better price and hence greater returns on their work in the fields. The farmers would also use the warehouse to store seeds and other commodities required for farming, thus preventing them from getting damaged. The warehouses will also prepare the farmers to face any future natural calamities and will help them build resources to help others. CARE TODAY had allocated a sum of Rs 35,18,250 for the construction of the warehouses while the community contributed Rs 4,50,000 for purchasing the land for the warehouses.

CARE TODAY was set up by the INDIA TODAY Group in 1999 to channelise financial contributions from readers for helping victims of calamities. Various projects undertaken by it in the last 10 years have done their bit for rekindling hope in the lives of those who had otherwise been dealt a debilitating blow. The various funds founded by CARE TODAY include "Lest We Forget" to help in the rehabilitation of the disabled soldiers of the Kargil war, "Hope for Orissa" for those devastated by the supercyclone, "Fight the Drought" for drought victims, "Rebuilding Gujarat" to help provide relief to those affected by the quake, "Make a Difference" for the tsunami victims, "Comfort Kashmir" for those hit by the earthquake in Jammu and Kashmir and the Bihar Flood Relief Fund to provide help to the victims of the Kosi flood.